

Clinical Immunogenicity Considerations for Biosimilar and Interchangeable Insulin Products

Guidance for Industry¹

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I. INTRODUCTION

The purpose of this guidance is to provide recommendations to applicants regarding whether and when comparative clinical immunogenicity studies may be needed to support licensure of proposed biosimilar and interchangeable recombinant human insulins, recombinant human insulin mix products, and recombinant insulin analog products that are intended for the treatment of patients with Type 1 or Type 2 diabetes mellitus (collectively described as “insulin products”). The recommendations in this guidance are applicable only to proposed biosimilar and interchangeable insulin products seeking licensure under section 351(k) of the Public Health Service Act (PHS Act) in biologics license applications (BLAs).

In general, FDA’s guidance documents do not establish legally enforceable responsibilities. Instead, guidances describe the Agency’s current thinking on a topic and should be viewed only as recommendations, unless specific regulatory or statutory requirements are cited. The use of the word *should* in Agency guidances means that something is suggested or recommended, but not required.

II. BACKGROUND

A. The Pathway for Biosimilar and Interchangeable Insulin Products

Section 7002(e)(4) of the Biologics Price Competition and Innovation Act of 2009 (BPCI Act) requires that on March 23, 2020, an approved application for a biological product under section 505 of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act (FD&C Act) (21 U.S.C. 355) will be deemed to be a license for the biological product under section 351 of the PHS Act (42 U.S.C. 262). Although the majority of therapeutic biological products have been licensed under section 351 of

¹ This guidance has been prepared by the Center for Drug Evaluation and Research (CDER) at the Food and Drug Administration (FDA or the Agency). We update guidances periodically. To make sure you have the most recent version of a guidance, check the FDA Drugs guidance web page at <https://www.fda.gov/drugs/guidance-compliance-regulatory-information/guidances-drugs>.